INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SAWS, HAND

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized Federal agencies to use this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification GGG-S-65a dated April 5, 1961.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers manually-operated hand saws for cutting wood, metal, plastics and similar materials. The saw consists of a flat blade with teeth on one or two edges, a handle, and attaching screws. Frame-type saws and blades, and one- and two-man crosscut saws are not included.

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and styles. Saws shall be of the following types and styles as specified (see 6.1):

Type I. - Back.
Type III. - Cable.
Type IV. - Compass.
Type V. - Crosscut.
Type VI. - Docking.
Type VII. Dovetail.
Type VIII. - Keyhole.
  Style A. - Woodcutting.
  Style B. - Metal-cutting.
Type IX. - Metal-cutting.
Type X. - Miter box.
Type XI. - Nested.
Type XII. - Plumbers'.
Type XIII. - Pruning.
Type XIV. - Rip.
Type XV. - Adjustable handle.
  Style A. - Compass blade.
  Style B. - Keyhole blade.
  Style C. - Nail-saw blade.

1.2.2 Sizes. Hand saws shall be of the sizes shown in tables I through XIV for each type and style as specified (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Federal Standards:
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 151 - Metals; Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:
MIL-H-15424 - Hand Tools, Packaging of.

Military Standards:
MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Illustrations. The illustrations herein are for the convenience of identification, and are not intended to preclude the purchase of saws otherwise conforming to this specification.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Blades. Saw blades shall be made of rolled saw steel which can be heat treated to the hardness requirements hereinafter specified, and perform the bending tests specified in section 4 for type V and XIV. The steel shall be free from cracks, segregations, inclusions, seams, hammer marks, high spots or other imperfections that may affect serviceability. When specified, except for types III, VIII, style B, IX, and XV (see 6.2) saw blades shall be of an alloy steel containing chromium and nickel. The chromimum plus nickel content shall not be less than 16% to prevent corrosion.

3.2.2 Handles.

3.2.2.1 Wooden handles. Wooden handles shall be made of thoroughly seasoned (not over 12-percent moisture) straight-grained, clear hardwood, free from any imperfections which may affect serviceability or durability. Handles of types I, III, V, VI, X, XII, and XIII saws shall have a handhole opening of not less than 3-3/4 inches in length by 1-1/8 inches in width.

3.2.2.2 Metal handles. Metal handles shall be of corrosion-resisting metal or shall have a suitable rust-resisting finish.

3.2.2.3 Plastic handles. Plastic handles shall be of a suitable fire-resistant or self-extinguishing plastic (see 4.4.4).

3.2.3 Screws, medallions, nuts and rivets, unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, shall be made of metal showing a Rockwell B hardness of not less than 60 and shall have a suitable rust-resisting coating or shall be of corrosion-resisting metal.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3.3 Nominal length. The nominal length of all saws, except type X, shall be the distance between the teeth nearest the ends of the saw blade. The thickness of the cutting edge shall be measured next to but not including the teeth.

3.4 Spring set teeth. Saws with spring set teeth shall have every tooth the same degree; alternate teeth shall be set to the same side of the saw. Ample clearance shall be provided on each side of the blade of all saws to prevent binding under service conditions.

3.5 Points and teeth per inch. Points and teeth per inch shall be measured as shown on figure 1 (see 6.1). (Note.-Always one more point than teeth per inch.)

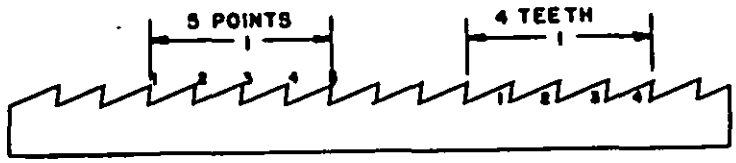


Figure 1. Points and teeth per inch.

3.6 Tolerances. When no tolerances are specified herein, a plus or minus tolerance of 10 percent will be permitted; a plus or minus tolerance of 0.003 inch will be permitted when uniform thickness is specified; and a plus or minus one point per inch will be permitted in points per inch, except on types V and X.

3.7 Thickness. Unless otherwise specified hereinafter, the blades shall be of uniform thickness throughout.

3.8 Finish.

3.8.1 Wood handles. Wood handles shall have polished and rounded edges. All exposed surfaces including the inside of the handgrip shall be finished smooth, stained and either wax-coated or lacquered with a durable weather-resistant lacquer or varnish.

3.8.2 Metal and plastic handles. Metal and plastic handles shall have smooth grips and be free from sharp edges and projections.

3.9 Marking for identification. Saws shall be permanently marked with the manufacturer's name, or with a trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined. The marking shall be applied in a manner that will preclude damage to the saws.

3.9.1 Special marking. When specified in the contract or order (see 6.1), special marking shall be permanently applied in accordance with the specifications listed herein. Special marking shall not damage or render the saw defective.

3.10 Type I, back saw. Type I saws shall be securely held in a reinforcing steel back 3/4 inch wide and 0.109 inch thick, extending the full length of the back of the blade. The blade shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 46 nor more than 52. The teeth shall be spring set, bevel-filed and adapted for both crosscutting and ripping. The handle shall be of hardwood and secured to the blade by means of three screws and nuts. The saws shall be similar to figure 2 and shall conform to the dimensions shown in table I for the length specified (see 6.1).

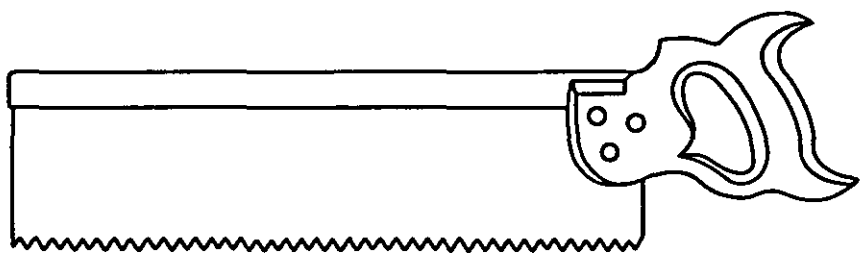


Figure 2. Type I, back saw.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE 1. Type 1, back saw.

Length of cutting edge	Width under back		Points per inch	Thickness of blade	
	Minimum	Maximum		Minimum	Maximum
Inches	Inches	Inches		Inch	Inch
12 ------	2-3/4	3-7/8	14	0.028	0.038
16 ------	3-1/2	4	12	.028	.042

3.11 Type III, cable saw. Type III saws shall consist of a flat tapered saw blade toothed on two edges for cutting cable. The handle shall be of hardwood and shall be secured by not less than three screws and nuts. The blade shall be heat treated and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 50 nor more than 58. Cable saws shall be similar to figure 3 and conform to the dimensions shown in table II.

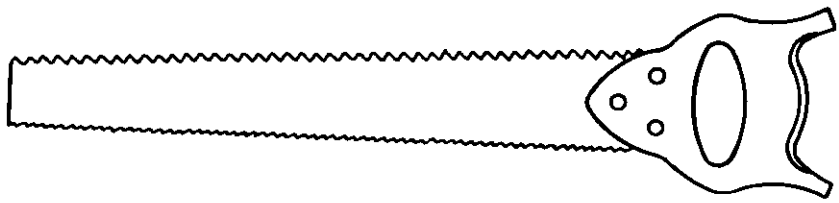


Figure 3. Type III, cable saw.

TABLE II. Type III, cable saw.

Length of cutting edge	Width of blade		Points per inch	Thickness of blade	
	Point	Handle		Minimum	Maximum
Inches	Inches	Inches		Inch	Inch
12	2	2-3/4	8 and 15	0.042	0.058

3.12 Type IV, compass saw. Type IV compass saw shall be tapered in width and of uniform thickness throughout the length of the cutting edge. The blade shall be either of uniform thickness throughout or tapered. The blade shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 44 nor more than 49. The teeth shall be spring set, filed and adapted for both cross-cutting and ripping. The handle shall be made of thoroughly seasoned, straight-grain hardwood, and shall be secured to the blade by means of either two screws and nuts or one screw and nut and one pin. The handle shall provide for interchanging of worn and new blades. Saw shall be similar to figure 4 and conform to the dimensions shown in table III.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

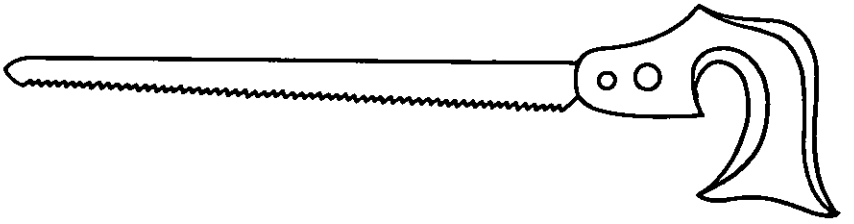


Figure 4. Type IV, compass saw.

TABLE III. Type IV, compass saw.

Length of cutting edge	Points per inch	Thickness of cutting edge		Blade width at handle	
		Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
Inches		Inch	Inch	Inch	Inch
12	9	.042	.065	1	1-3/8

3.13 Type V, crosscut saw. Type V saw blades shall be of the skew or straight back type as specified (see 6.1), true and full taper ground. Blades, at the tooth edge, shall be not less than .032 inch nor more than .044 inch, and of the same thickness along this entire length. Blades shall taper uniformly from butt to point and from tooth edge to back. Blade thickness of back at point shall be .022 inches ± .003. The teeth shall be alternately spring set not more than one-half the depth of the tooth, and bevel filed for cross-cutting. The blade shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell "C" hardness of not less than 46 nor more than 52. The handle on 24 and 26 inch saws shall be secured by at least 4 screws, or 3 screws and one medallion. The handles on saw sizes smaller than 24 inches shall be secured by at least 3 screws, or 2 screws and one medallion. The handles shall be firmly secured to the blade without showing looseness or rocking under actual or simulated service conditions. Type V saws shall be similar to figures 5 or 6 and conform to the dimensions shown in table IV for the length specified (see 6.1). The crosscut saws shall be capable of withstanding the bending test of 4.4.3.

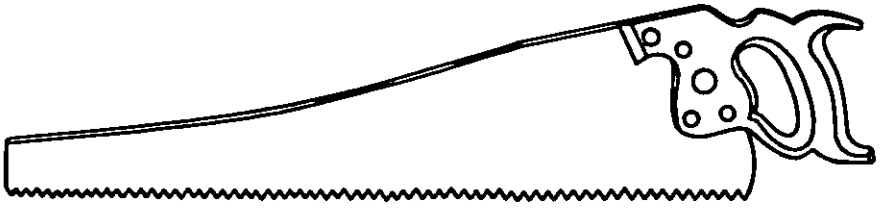


Figure 5. Type V, crosscut, skew back.

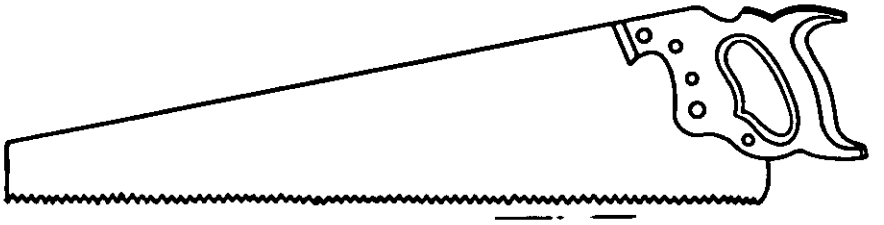


Figure 6. Type V, crosscut, straight back.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Type V, crosscut saws.

Length of cutting edge / 1-3/8 - 1/2	Points per inch	Width	
		Butt	Point (min.)
20	10	5	1-1/4
24	10	6	1-1/4
26	6 or 8	6-1/2	1-1/2

3.14 Type VI docking saw. Type VI saw shall be of the skew-back type. The blade shall be of uniform thickness throughout the length of the cutting edge. It shall be taper ground from the handle end of the saw to the end of the blade and from the cutting edge to the back. Blade shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 46 nor more than 52, and shall be filed and spring set. The handle shall be of metal with corrosion-resisting finish and shall be secured to the blade by two or more rivets. Docking saw shall be similar to figure 7 and shall conform to the dimensions shown in table V.

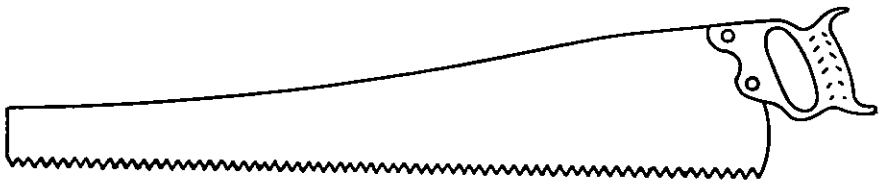


Figure 7. Type VI, docking saw.

TABLE V. Type VI, docking saw.

Length of cutting edge +1-3/8 -1/2	Points per inch	Thickness of cutting edge		Thickness of back at point		Width	
		Minimum	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum	Handle end	Point
Inches		Inch	Inch	Inch	Inch	Inches	Inches
30 --------	4-1/2	.045	.055	.032	.042	6-1/2	2-1/2

3.15 Type VII, dovetail saw. Type VII saws shall be fitted with a reinforcing steel back extending the full length of the blade. The blade shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 46 nor more than 52. The teeth shall be spring set, bevel filed, and adapted for both crosscutting and ripping. A handle of the straight grip type shall be securely fastened to reinforcing back. Dovetail saws shall be similar to figure 8 and shall conform to the dimensions show in table VI for the length specified (see 6.1).

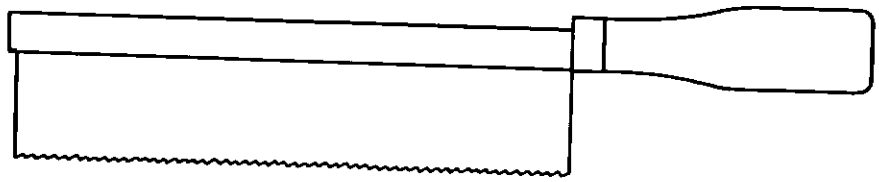


Figure 8. Type VII, dovetail saw.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VI. Type VII, dovetail saws.

Length of blade +1-3/8 -1/2	Width under back	Points per inch	Thickness of blade	
			Minimum	Maximum
Inches	Inches		Inch	Inch
8 --------	1-5/8	16	0.018	0.025
10 --------	1-5/8	16	.018	.025

3.16 Type VIII, keyhole saw.

3.16.1 Style A, woodcutting. Type VIII, style A woodcutting keyhole saws shall be of tapered width and uniform thickness throughout the length of the cutting edge. The blade shall be either of uniform thickness throughout or tapered. The blade shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 44 nor more than 49. The teeth shall be spring set, and adapted for both cross-cutting and ripping. The handle shall be made of thoroughly seasoned, straight-grain hardwood, and shall be secured to the blade by means of either two screws and nuts, or one screw and nut and one pin. The handle shall provide for interchanging of worn and new blades. Saws shall be similar to figure 9 and conform to the dimensions shown in table VII.

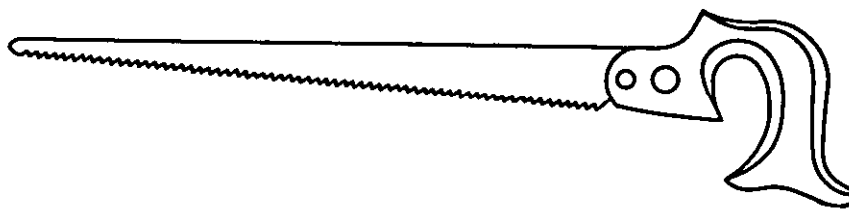


Figure 9. Type VIII, style A, keyhole saw, woodcutting.

TABLE VII. Type VIII, style A, keyhole saw, woodcutting.

Length of cutting edge	Points per inch	Thickness of cutting edge		Blade width at handle	
		Minimum	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum
Inches		Inch	Inch	Inch	Inch
10 ----------	10	0.042	0.060	1/2	13/16

3.16.2 Style B, metal-cutting. Type VIII, style B, metal-cutting keyhole saws shall consist of a detachable metal handle and a short tapered metal-cutting blade. The handle shall be of the pistol-grip type and shall be designed to fit a 3/4-inch wide steel saw blade and hold it securely in place. The blade width shall be tapered from 3/4-inch at the handle end to 3/16-inch at the point. The blade shall have a Rockwell C hardness of 58 to 62, and shall be capable of withstanding the metal cutting test of 4.4.2.2. The saw shall be similar to figure 10 and conform to the dimensions shown in table VIII.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

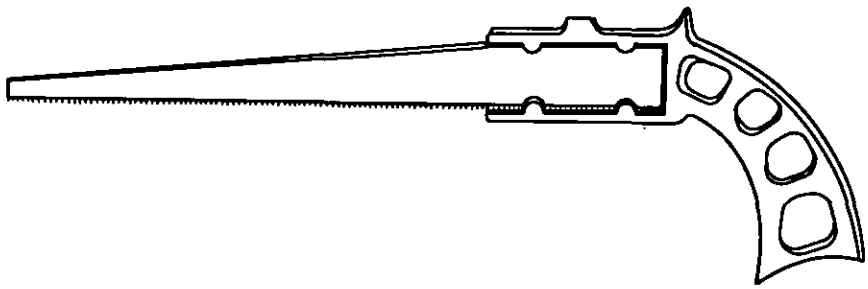


Figure 10. Type VIII, style B, keyhole saw, metal cutting.

TABLE VIII. Type VIII, style B, keyhole saw, metal cutting.

Overall length of blade 1/8	Length of cutting edge, beyond handle (Min.)	Points per inch	Blade thickness		Blade width in handle
			Min.	Max.	
Inches	Inches		Inch	Inch	Inch
7-1/2	5-1/2	24	0.025	0.040	3/4

3.17 Type IX, metal-cutting. Type IX saw shall be of the straight-back type and either taper-ground or taper and hollow ground. It shall be of uniform thickness throughout the length of the cutting edge. The back of the saw may be of uniform gage throughout or tapered from the handle to the point. The blade shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 52 nor more than 58, and shall be capable of withstanding the test of 4.4.2.1. The teeth shall not be set, but shall be milled straight across. The handle shall be made of hardwood and shall be secured to the blade by means of either three or four screws and nuts. Type IX saws shall be similar to figure 6 and conform to the dimensions shown in table IX.

TABLE IX. Type IX, metal-cutting saw.

Length of cutting edge +1-3/8 -1/2	Points per inch	Thickness of cutting edge		Thickness of back at handle		Thickness of back at point		Width	
		Minimum	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum	Butt	Point
Inches		Inch	Inch	Inch	Inch	Inch	Inch	Inches	Inches
18---------	15	0.042	0.049	0.032	0.049	0.022	0.025	5-1/4	1-9/16

3.18 Type X, miter box saw. Type X saw shall be securely held in a reinforcing steel back 1-inch wide, 0.109 inch thick and extending the full length of the back. The blade shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 46 nor more than 52. The teeth shall be spring set, bevel filed and adapted for both crosscutting and ripping. The handle shall be of hardwood and secured to the blade by not less than three screws and nuts. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), saw shall be similar to either figure 11(a) or 11(b), and conform to the dimensions shown in table X. The functional length of the saw shall be at least 23-inches, as measured in two places (1) along the cutting edge, and (2) from the far end of the saw, up to the start of the wooden handle.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

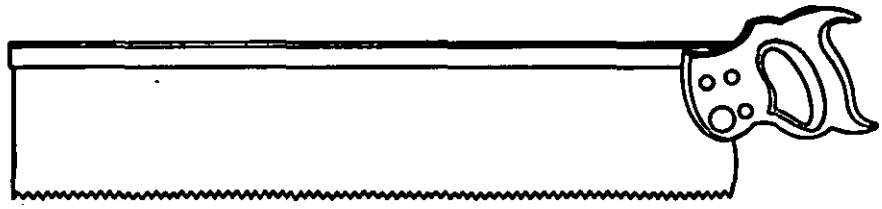


Figure 11(a). Type X, miter box saws.

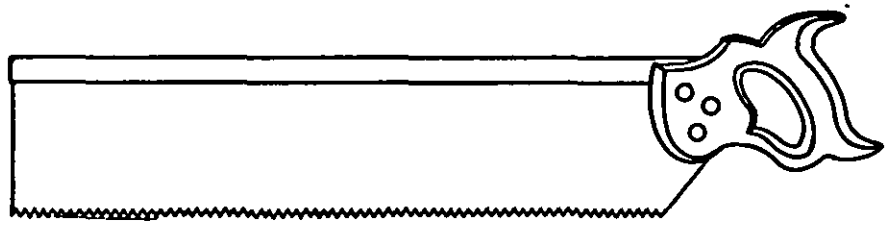


Figure 11(b). Type X, miter box saws.

TABLE X. Type X, miter box saws.

Full length of blade +2 -3/4	Width under back	Points per inch	Thickness of blade	
		Minimum	Minimum	Maximum
Inches	Inches		Inch	Inch
26 -----	4	11	0.037	0.043

3.19 Type XI, nested saw. Type XI nested saws shall consist essentially of three blades and a detachable hardwood handle similar to figure 12, provided with a device for quickly and securely attaching handle to blade. The nest shall consist of a keyhole saw, compass saw, and nail-cutting saw. The handle end of each blade shall be properly designed to fit the handle; otherwise, the keyhole saw blade shall conform to the 10-inch type VIII keyhole saw (see 3.16.1), and the compass saw blade to the 12-inch type IV compass saw (see 3.12). The nail-cutting saw blade shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 49 nor more than 52. The nail cutting blade shall be capable of withstanding the metal cutting test of 4.4.2.2. The blade shall be of uniform thickness throughout the length of the cutting edge. The blade shall be either of uniform thickness throughout or tapered. The teeth shall be set and milled straight across. They shall conform to the dimensions shown in table XI.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

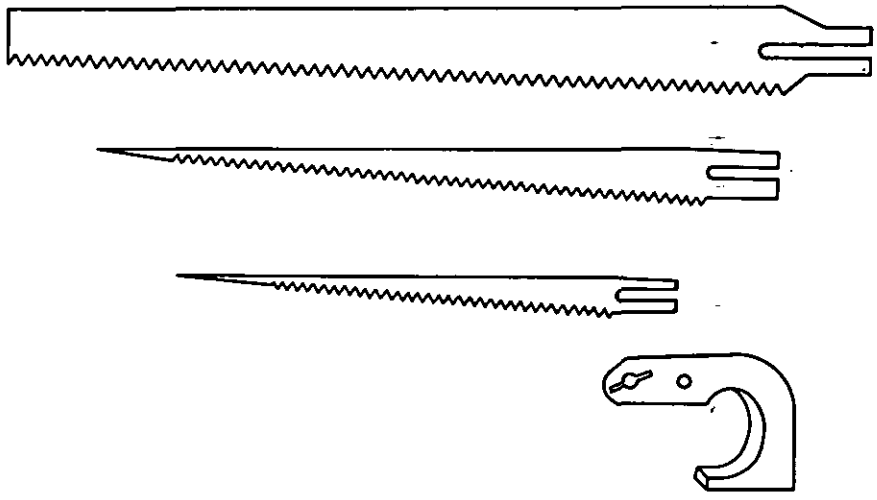


Figure 12. Type XI, nested saws (nailcutting, keyhole and compass blades with handle).

TABLE XI. Type XI, nail-cutting blade for nested saws.

Length of cutting edge	Points per inch	Thickness of cutting edge (uniform or tapered)		Thickness of back at point (tapered only)		Blade width at handle	
		Minimum	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum
Inches		Inch	Inch	Inch	Inch	Inches	Inches
14 to 18 ---	15	0.042	0.048	0.032	0.035	1-7/8	2-1/8

3.20 Type XII, plumbers' saw. Type XII saws shall be of a straight-back type, toothed on one edge and have a reversible hardwood handle secured by one bolt and wingnut. It shall be suitable for cutting studs, rafters, and flooring, where nails are imbedded. The blade shall be of uniform thickness on the cutting edge and taper ground for clearance. It shall have a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 48 nor more than 52 and shall be capable of withstanding the test of 4.4.2.2. The teeth shall not be set but shall be milled straight across. Type XII saws shall be similar to figure 13 and conform to the dimensions shown in table XII.

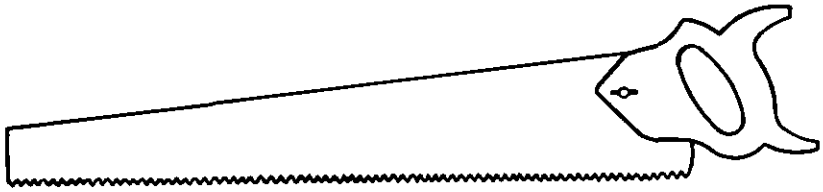


Figure 13. Plumbers' saw.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE XII. Type XII, plumbers' saw.

Length of cutting edge +1-3/8 -1/2	Points per inch	Thickness of cutting edge		Thickness of back		Width	Width
		Minimum	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum		
Inches		Inch	Inch	Inch	Inch	Inches	Inches
18 --------	12	0.035	0.049	0.022	0.028	1-3/4	3-1/2

3.21 Type XIII, pruning saw. Pruning saw shall have a straight tapering blade with a double horn hardwood handle secured by three screws and nuts. The blade shall have teeth on both edges and shall be of uniform thickness throughout its length. The teeth on one edge shall be bevel filed and spring set for crosscutting with eight points per inch, and the other edge shall have teeth known as lumberman style. The blades shall be hardened and tempered to a Rockwell C hardness of not less than 46 nor more than 52. Pruning saw shall be similar to figure 14, and conform to the dimensions shown in table XIII.

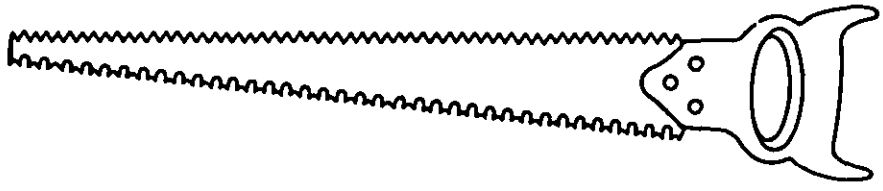


Figure 14. Type XIII, pruning saw.

TABLE XIII. Type XIII, pruning saws.

Length of blade +1-3/8 -1/2	Thickness on cutting edge		Width at point		Width at handle end	
	Minimum	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum	Minimum	Maximum
Inches	Inch	Inch	Inch	Inches	Inches	Inches
18 -------	0.040	0.046	3/4	1	2-5/8	2-3/4

3.22 Type XIV, rip saw. Type XIV rip saw shall conform to type V, crosscut saws (see 3.13) except dimensions shall be as specified in table XIV. The teeth shall be filed straight across and adapted for ripping. Saw shall be similar to figures 5 or 6, and conform to the dimensions shown in table XIV.

TABLE XIV. Type XIV, rip saw.

Length of cutting edge +1-3/8 -1/2	Points per inch	Width	
		Butt ±1	Point
Inches		Inches	Inches
26	5-1/2	6	1-3/4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.23 Type XV, adjustable handle saw. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), each adjustable handle shall be furnished with three blades (one each of styles A, B, and C, see 3.23.4, 3.23.5, and 3.23.6). When specified (see 6.1), each type XV adjustable handle saw shall be furnished with either a style A, B, or C (see 3.23.4, 3.23.5, and 3.23.6) blade(s). Each blade shall have a cutting edge not less than 11-inches long, beyond the handle.

3.23.1 Type XV handles. The blade-holding device of the handles shall be designed to securely hold either of the blade ends shown in figure 15 without any blade movement in any direction when the thumbnut is tightened. Handles shall be of plastic or cast metal. The handles shall be of the pistol-grip design with a swiveling chuck and locking pin which permits the blade to be rotated through 360° and can be securely locked in at least eight positions at equal intervals of 45°. The chuck shall be of such design as to accommodate styles A, B, and C blades. The finished surfaces of the clutch, locking pin and knurled nut shall be made of noncorrosive metal, or shall have a corrosive-resistant finish. The plastic handle shall pass the flammability test of 4.4.4. Handles shall be similar to figure 16.

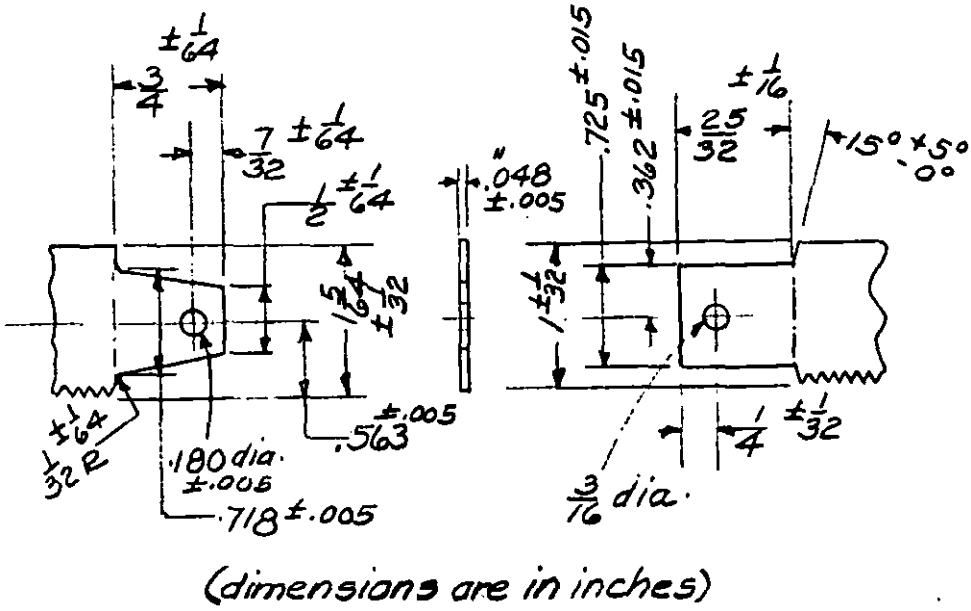


Figure 15. Type XV, blade handle ends.

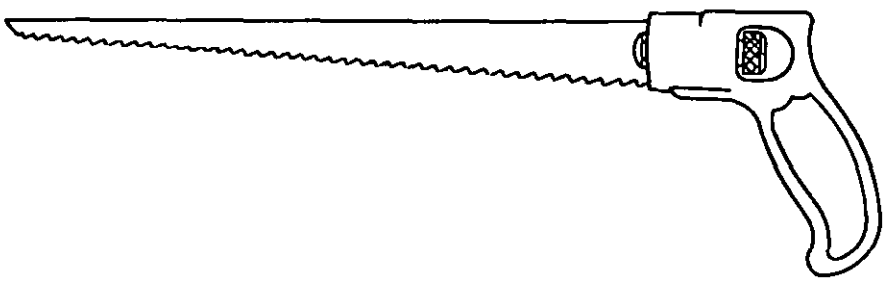


Figure 16. Type XV, adjustable handle.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.23.2 Styles A, B and C blades. Styles A, B and C blades shall be of uniform thickness throughout the length of the cutting edge and back.

3.23.3 Handle end of the blades. The handle end of the style A, B, and C blades must be interchangeable between the plastic and metal handles and shall be capable of being securely held in the blade-holding device of either handle without blade movement in any direction. The handle end of the style A, B, and C blades shall conform to either of the ends shown in figure 15, or may be of a different style, or may vary from the dimensions shown, provided they can be securely held in either the plastic or metal handle.

3.23.4 Style A compass blade. Style A adjustable handle saw blades shall have a Rockwell C hardness value of from 44 to 49. The teeth shall be formed, set and filed. The blade shall have 7 teeth (8 points) per inch.

3.23.5 Style B, keyhole blade. Style B adjustable handle saw blade shall have a Rockwell C hardness value of from 58 to 62 and shall contain 24 teeth (25 points) per inch. The blades shall be capable of withstanding the cutting test specified in 4.4.2.1.

3.23.6 Style C, nail saw blade. Style C adjustable handle saw blade shall have a Rockwell C hardness value of from 58 to 62 and shall contain 10 teeth (11 points) per inch. The blades shall be capable of withstanding the metal cutting test specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.24 Workmanship. The blades of the saws shall be true and straight throughout their length and width. The workmanship, finish, and appearance of saws shall be first class in every respect.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection of materials and components. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified herein, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Sampling procedures. Sampling procedures shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Data for sampling shall be as stated in table XV.

TABLE XV. Sampling data.

Category	Sample Unit	Inspection Level	Acceptable Quality Level	AQL Expressed In Terms Of	Reference
Visual examination	1 each	II	1.5	Percent defective	4.3.1
Dimensional examination	1 each	II	1.5	Percent defective	4.3.2
Testing	1 each	II	1.5	Percent defective	4.4.1
	1 each	S-4	2.5	Percent defective	4.4.2 4.4.3
	1 each	S-3	1.0	Percent defective	4.4.4
Preparation for delivery	one container	S-2	4.0	Defects per hundred units	4.5

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual examination. Each sample unit shall be examined for any non-conformance in design, material, finish, coating, construction, workmanship, and marking. Defects are listed in table XVI.

TABLE XVI. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical:	
1	None defined.
Major:	
101	Type, style and (if applicable) number of points per inch of saw not as specified.
102	Blade defective; evidence of cracks, segregations, inclusion, seams, high spots, or hammer marks; blade crimped or warped.
103	Teeth not spring set, teeth not uniformly set, not adapted for both cross-cutting and ripping, or teeth fail to provide ample clearance on either side of blade, or tooth set extends too deep causing broken teeth, cracked teeth, or other defects.
104	Teeth not sharpened as specified; evidence of nicks, burrs, dull or incompletely formed teeth; teeth improperly formed or not even and of uniform height.
105	Reinforcing back not the required material, not secured to blade, fails to extend the full length of the blade.
106	Blade width not tapered (types III, IV, VIII, XI and XIII).
107	Handle defective, fails to securely hold the saw blades, saw blades not readily interchangeable, or handle not the required style or material; evidence of cracks, checking, soft spots, heavy knots; wood not straight-grained.
108	Blade not corrosion resistant (if applicable).
Minor:	
201	Handle not finished as required; evidence of fins or burrs (type VI only).
202	Marking, manufacturer's name or trademark missing, illegible, or not permanent.

4.3.2 Dimensional and weight examination. Each sample unit shall be examined for any nonconformance with dimensional and weight requirements.

4.4 Testing. Each sample unit shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.1 through 4.4.4.

4.4.1 Hardness. Each sample saw blade shall be subjected to a hardness test in accordance with Method 243.1 of Fed. Std. No. 151 to determine conformance with the applicable requirement specified in section 3.

4.4.2 Metal-cutting.

4.4.2.1 Types IX and XV, style B. Types IX and XV, style B, metal-cutting hand saws shall be given a performance test as follows: They shall make a 24-inch cut in #16 gage (0.058) hot rolled sheet steel ASTM-A 415 freely and shall show no damage to the teeth after completion of cut.

4.4.2.2 Type VIII, style B, type XI, type XII, and type XV, style C. Type VIII, style B, type XI, type XII, and type XV, style C saws shall be given the following test: They shall cut through a piece of 2- by 4-inch lumber and four 16-penny common wire nails driven into it at a 45° angle to the cut without damage to the blade.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.3 Bending test (types V and XIV). The blades of types V and XIV saws shall be subjected to the following test: The saw blade shall be bent slowly around a wooden mandrel 12-inches in diameter until the handle end of the saw is at 90 degrees with the point end; the bend shall be made half-way from the point to the handle. The saw shall be bent alternately through three cycles and shall show no greater deflection than 1/8-inch in the length of the saw blade. After the bending test has been made, the inspector shall procure a C clamp and a straight metal test bar at least 28-inches long. With the teeth of the saw lying adjacent to the edge of the test bar, the inspector shall clamp the saw blade to the test bar within one inch of the butt end of the blade, having the bowed side (if any) of the blade outwardly from the test bar. The inspector shall then measure the deflection at the point end of the saw blade, and if the deflection exceeds 1/8-inch, or if there are cracks, the saw shall be considered as nonconforming.

4.4.4 Flammability test. The handle for test shall be clamped in a support with the handle extended outward in a horizontal position. Under the handle there shall be clamped a piece of 10-mesh Bunsen burner gauze about 5 inches square, in a horizontal position, 1/4-inch below the bottom of the handle, and with about 1/2-inch of the handle extending beyond the edge of the gauze. A Bunsen burner with an efficient flame 1/2 to 3/4-inch in height, shall be adjusted so that the flame tip will just contact the specimen when placed under the free end of the handle. At the end of 30 seconds the flame shall be removed and the sample allowed to burn. The rate of travel of the flame shall be determined from the time required for the flame to travel the length of the handle after the removal of the Bunsen burner. In case the handle does not continue to burn after the first ignition, the burner shall be replaced under the free end for a period of 30 seconds immediately following the extinction of the flame. If the handle does not continue to burn until the flame has reached the blade end of the handle after the second ignition, the sample shall be considered self-extinguishing. If the sample continues to burn, the burning rate shall not exceed 2-inches per minute.

4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the preservation, packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table XVII The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot.

TABLE XVII. Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the saws shall be preserved, packaged, and packed in accordance with MIL-H-15424. The level of preservation and packaging shall be A or C and the level of packing shall be A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type, style, and length of saws required (see 1.2.1, 1.2.2 and applicable table of dimensions).
(c) Number of points per inch (see figure 1 and 3.5).
(d) Special marking of saws, if required (see 3.9.1).
(e) Whether skew or straight back type saw required (see 3.13).
(f) Specify if preference of (a) or (b) style saw is required (see 3.18 and figure 11).
(g) When applicable, state requirement for either style A, B, or C blade(s) to be furnished with each type XV saw handle (see 3.23).
(h) Levels of preservation, packaging and packing required (see 5.1).
(i) State when saw blades except for types III, VIII style B, IX and XV shall be corrosion resistant chrome-nickel alloy steel (see 3.2.1).

6.2 Supersession data. The classification of saws covered in this specification corresponding to those covered in Federal Specification GGG-S-65a are as follows:

GGG-S-65a	GGG-S-0065b(GSA-FSS)
Type I. - Back.	Type I. - Back.
Type II. - Cabinet.	Deleted.
Type III. - Cable	Type III. - Cable.
Type IV. - Compass	Type IV. Compass.
Type V. - Crosscut.	Type V. - Crosscut.
Style A. - Skew back.	
Style B. - Straight back.	
Class 1. - Full taper ground.	
Class 2. - Flat ground.	
Type VI. - Docking.	Type VI. - Docking.
Type VII. - Dovetail.	Type VII. - Dovetail.
Type VIII. - Keyhole.	Type VIII. - Keyhole.
Style A. - Woodcutting.	Style A. - Woodcutting.
Style B. - Metal-cutting.	Style B. - Metal-cutting.
Type IX. - Metal-cutting.	Type IX. - Metal-cutting.
Type X. - Miter box.	Type X. - Miter box.
Type XI. - Nested.	Type XI. - Nested.
Type XII. - Plumbers .	Type XII. - Plumbers'.
Type XIII. - Pruning.	Type XIII. - Pruning.
Style A. - Single edge.	Deleted.
Style B. - Double edge.	Deleted.
Type XIV. - Rip.	Type XIV. - Rip.
Style A. - Skew back.	
Style B. - Straight back.	
Class 1. - Full taper ground.	
Class 2. - Flat ground.	
Type XV. - Adjustable handle.	Type XV. - Adjustable handle.
Class 1. - Plastic handle.	
Class 2. - Metal handle.	
Style A. - Compass blade.	Style A. - Compass blade.
Style B. - Keyhole blade.	Style B. - Keyhole blade.
Style C. - Nail-saw blade.	Style C. - Nail-saw blade.

GSA DC 67-20062
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.